

neurodivers³

Signals & Status Messages

For when full sentences are too expensive.

Short, pre-agreed messages for shutdown, cancelling, going quiet, and coming back.

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Signals explained

For when full sentences are too expensive.

A signal is a small pre-agreed thing that says: I am not ignoring you. I am low-capacity. Please do not make me explain from scratch. It can be an emoji, a single word, a colour, an app status, a GIF, or one pre-written sentence. The form matters less than the agreement.

Examples:

● = low words · "quiet mode" · "red day" · a pinned text message · a status in Slack/Discord/WhatsApp · a single emoji sent to one safe person.

Pick one. Tell your people. That is the whole system.

My signal is

People who should know

Copy-paste status templates

These messages are pre-written and ready to customise.

Can't talk now

I cannot talk properly right now. I am safe. I will message when I have words again.

Need two hours alone

I need two hours without conversation. Nothing is wrong between us. I just need the quiet version of being here.

Need quiet company

I do not want to be alone, but I also cannot talk much. Quiet company would help.

Cancelling today

I need to cancel today. My capacity has dropped and I would rather be honest than push through and pay for it later.

Will explain later

I cannot explain this properly right now. I will come back to it when my brain is online again.

Safe, shutting down

I am safe, but I am shutting down. Please do not ask lots of questions yet.

Reaching out before a crash

I think I am heading for a crash and I am trying to say it before I disappear.

Coming back online

I am starting to come back online. I might still be slow, but I am here.

Which one do I send?

A simple decision tree to route you to the right template fast.

Q1 Am I safe?

No → contact local emergency/help support

Yes → continue



Q2 Do I need distance or quiet company?

Distance → "Need two hours alone"

Quiet company → "Need quiet company"



Q3 Am I cancelling, explaining later, or shutting down?

Cancelling → "Cancelling today"

Explaining later → "Will explain later"

Shutting down → "Safe, shutting down"



Q4 Am I trying to prevent a crash?

Yes → "Reaching out before a crash"

No → use the shortest message that tells the truth

The right message is the one you can actually send.

Customise without breaking the point

You are allowed to make these sound like you. You are also allowed to keep them blunt. Low-capacity communication does not need to win a writing prize.

Who needs a warmer version?

Who needs a firmer version?

Which word would I never use?

What detail do I usually over-explain?

What can I remove?

Where will I save the finished version?

The template does not have to be elegant. It has to be reachable.

Before you go

Where this fits

Bad-Day Protocol

The printable version for your people.

neurodivers3.co.uk/store

The Good-Day Conversation

Agree it all on a good day.

neurodivers3.co.uk/store

Masking Recovery Pack

For the recovery after.

neurodivers3.co.uk/store

Newsletter

One honest email when there's something worth saying.

neurodivers3.co.uk/newsletter

About neurodivers³

neurodivers³ is a home for honest stories, practical tools, and ideas for making everyday life work better with a neurodivergent brain. I make resources for late-diagnosed and self-identified neurodivergent adults who are tired of being told to try harder at systems that were never built for them. This resource is not a clinical tool. It is a practical one. Use what helps; leave what does not.

— Ollie

Feedback invitation:

If one of these templates became the message you actually send, tell me at

hello@neurodivers3.co.uk.

Refundable for 14 days, no questions. Email hello@neurodivers3.co.uk within 14 days of purchase.